UPSC Current Affairs

Tuesday, 10 November 2026 · Sources: PIB and The Hindu · 60 items

Paper	Items	Top headlines
GS1	6	Falling fertility rate makes two-child penalties outdated in; Cyber bullying affects one in ten students worldwide; AI fue
GS2	30	Trump says likely to meet Putin, Xi at China APEC summit; ISRO’s latest navigation satellite NVS-03 is fully healthy,
GS3	24	Why Rayalaseema farmers fear a bumper crop more than drought; Countdown progressing for ISRO’s crucial GSLV-F18 launch car

Every item links to its original source: tap a headline or the Source line to open the full article on thehindu.com or the press release on pib.gov.in. The Hindu text here is only the short RSS excerpt.

GS Paper I: Heritage, Culture, History, Geography & Society

ECONOMY

Centre earmarks ■2,814 crore to boost lithium, nickel processing

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Geography, Governance & Social Justice

• In a social media post, Union Coal and Mines Minister G.
• Kishan Reddy stated the scheme would help strengthen domestic capabilities, boost manufacturing and reduce dependence on imports.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Union Coal and Mines Minister, Kishan Reddy

Source: The Hindu, Economy, 04 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/centre-earmarks-2814-crore-to-boost-lithium-nick

GEOGRAPHY

Beyond Cyclone Arnab: can India tackle the growing cost of natural disasters? | Insight India

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, Disaster Management, Environment & Ecology

• Cyclone Arnab hit the coast of Andhra Pradesh this week.
• In preparation, authorities evacuated people, halted transportation services and alerted disaster response forces.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Beyond Cyclone Arnab, Insight India, Cyclone Arnab, Andhra Pradesh

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/videos/shows/beyond-cyclone-arnab-can-india-tackle-the-growing-co

Trump to meet Iran war mediator Qatar, no imminent deal seen to end war

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Geography, International Relations, Agriculture

• Mutual attacks continue, with the U.S.
• striking Iran's Qeshm island overnight, according to Iranian state media, and Iran attacking tankers in the Gulf and ■Strait of Hormuz this month while its Yemeni Houthi allies have hit Saudi Arabia

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Trump, Iran, Qatar, Mutual, Qeshm

Source: The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/trump-to-meet-iran-war-mediator-qatar-no-immin

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

Festivals, infections and more | Health Wrap Ep. 58

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology, History & Art and Culture

• In the 58th episode of Health Wrap by The Hindu, Ramya Kannan, Health Editor, The Hindu, and Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu, discuss the public health concerns surrounding festivals, marking Diwali, including air pollution and AQI

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Festivals, Health Wrap Ep, Health Wrap, Hindu, Ramya Kannan

Source: The Hindu, Health, 07 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/festivals-infections-and-more-health-wrap-ep-58/a

INDIAN SOCIETY

Falling fertility rate makes two-child penalties outdated in India, says Supreme Court

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Indian Society, Governance & Social Justice

• ‘The foundation of such laws, that is, the fear of overpopulation, has crumbled due to demographic changes in the past few decades’, says Bench

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Falling, Supreme Court, Bench

Source: The Hindu, Health, 05 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/rolling-effect-of-decelerating-population-growth-ve

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Cyber bullying affects one in ten students worldwide; AI fuels new threat: UNESCO

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations, Science & Technology, History & Art and Culture

• The United Nations agency has called upon countries to invest in digital safety measures, teacher preparation, and mental health support for students, in coordination with technology companies

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cyber, UNESCO, United Nations

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/cyber-bullying-affects-one-in-ten-students-worldw

GS Paper II: Polity, Governance, Social Justice & IR

AGRICULTURE

Where have Bengaluru’s signature fruits gone?

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• From Bangalore Blue to Devanahalli chakota, villages around Bengaluru were once known for many horticultural crops.
• The exponential growth of the city, changing weather patterns and poor water availability have resulted in a dramatic shirinkage of the area under cultivation, writes Rashmi Patil

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Where, Bengaluru, From Bangalore Blue, Devanahalli, Rashmi Patil

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 08 Aug 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/karnataka/where-have-bengalurus-signature-fruits-go

Roadside vendors turned exporters: Meghalaya’s ‘numbered’ farmers reap fruits of labour

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture, International Relations, Economy

• A 433-member organic farmers’ producer company in Ri-Bhoi district’s Jirang has become a model of successful farm collectivisation

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Roadside, Meghalaya, Ri-Bhoi, Jirang

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 04 Jul 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/meghalaya/roadside-vendors-turned-exporters-meghala

ECONOMY

How neoliberalism turned the world against its young

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Governance & Social Justice

• The rise in youth unrest stems from failures of neoliberal capitalism, which has weakened public welfare and worsened unemployment; as falling wages undermine consumption and investment, young people face fewer jobs, rising education costs and an economic system that prioritises profits

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: How

Source: The Hindu, Economy, 28 Oct 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/how-neoliberalism-turned-the-world-against-its-y

Even as unemployment falls, lack of ‘decent work’ in India

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy, Governance & Social Justice, Science & Technology

• Poor-quality employment generation has consequences for economic growth; workers without social security spend less, save less and remain vulnerable to economic shocks

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Even, Poor-quality

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 04 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/even-as-unemployment-falls-lack-of-decent-work-in-in

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

Heat-trapping carbon pollution drops, but scientists cite Iran war rather than energy progress

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution, International Relations

• In 2026, the world emitted 42.2 billion tonne of heat-trapping carbon dioxide from the burning of fossil fuels such as coal, oil and gas.
• It's a 0.4% decrease from last year, according to the scientists of the Global Carbon Project

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Heat-trapping, Iran, Global Carbon Project

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/heat-trapping-carbon-pollution-dr

A case for Nepal: suing major carbon emitters for floods

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• While climate wrongs harm society, they do not harm individuals in a sufficiently direct and proximate way

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Nepal

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/a-case-for-nepal-suing-major-carbon-emitters-for-fl

India’s next investment cycle will shape its carbon future

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Governance & Social Justice, Economy

• Its future emissions will depend on what it chooses to build now and the technologies and standards incorporated into those investments

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Its

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 27 Oct 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/indias-next-investment-cycle-will-shape-its-carbon-

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

ED attaches properties in Kashmir in ‘misuse’ of PM Employment Generation Programme scheme case

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Economy, Science & Technology

• An ED spokesman said there was misappropriation of PMEGP Scheme’s loans in criminal conspiracy with the PMEGP borrowers, bank officials of Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch of J&K Bank and other unknown persons

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Kashmir, PM Employment Generation Programme, PMEGP Scheme, PMEGP, Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch

Source: The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jammu-and-kashmir/ed-attaches-properties-in-kashmir

Towards recognising women farmers

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Agriculture, Polity & Constitution

• Maharashtra’s passage of the Women Farmers’ Empowerment Bill, granting women independent recognition as farmers irrespective of land ownership, brings into focus the structural bias against the female agricultural workforce, highlights the need for a database of women farmers and using it to ensure access to welfare schemes

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Towards, Maharashtra, Women Farmers, Empowerment Bill

Source: The Hindu, Economy, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/towards-recognising-women-farmers/article7149702

Supreme Court terms vehicular emissions major contributor to air pollution in Delhi-NCR

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology, Polity & Constitution

• The Bench highlighted the large number of vehicles plying on roads connecting Delhi with neighbouring areas, including Ghaziabad, Greater Noida, Gurugram and Faridabad

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Supreme Court, Delhi-NCR, Bench, Delhi, Ghaziabad

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-terms-vehicular-emissions-major-contr

At sixes and sevens, the ECI’s growing credibility crisis

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice

• The Election Commission of India’s actions and questions around Forms 6 and 7 deepen doubts about its impartiality and transparency

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: ECI, Election Commission of India, Forms

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 17 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/at-sixes-and-sevens-the-ecis-growing-credibility-cri

NMC cautions students against fake medical colleges, asks them to verify approvals

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice

• The advisory follows the Supreme Court taking cognisance of the issue in an ongoing case in which the court directed regulatory bodies, including the National Medical Commission, to caution students and parents against dealing with unauthorised educational institutions

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: NMC, Supreme Court, National Medical Commission

Source: The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/nmc-cautions-students-against-fake-medical-colleges

Anaemia burden — iron alone is no solution

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice

• India must tackle its anaemia burden through targeted nutrition, better diagnostics and comprehensive public health measures, not salt fortification alone

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Anaemia

Source: The Hindu, Science, 05 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/anaemia-burden-iron-alone-is-no-solution/article7166

Deepavali pollution spike: How does it affect lung function and respiratory health? | Explained

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology

• Firecracker smoke releases fine particles and harmful gases that irritate the airways and affect lung health.
• Experts explain the short- and long-term effects of exposure and whether the damage persists after air quality improves

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Deepavali, How, Explained, Firecracker

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/deepavali-pollution-spike-how-does-it-affect-lung

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Trump says likely to meet Putin, Xi at China APEC summit

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• President Donald Trump indicated to reporters that a deal on the Russia-Ukraine war, the Iran issue and nuclear arms control would be on the agenda

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Trump, Putin, China APEC, President Donald Trump, Russia-Ukraine

Source: The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/us-china-russia-leaders-to-meet-next-week-says

Double standards: On the Trump diesel deal with Russia

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• The United States must stop moralising to the Global South for trading with Russia

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Double, the Trump, Russia, United States, Global South

Source: The Hindu, Editorial, 16 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/editorial/double-standards-on-the-trump-diesel-deal-with-

G7 Ministers meet on efforts to end Ukraine conflict, halt new Iran war

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• Ministers from the leading industrialised nations of Britain, Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and the United States will be gathering with preoccupations strikingly similar to those of the last such meeting in March

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: G7 Ministers, Ukraine, Iran, Ministers, Britain

Source: The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/g7-ministers-meeting-in-paris-russia-ukraine-c

Tens of thousands march in Amsterdam, pressing Dutch government on Gaza, Israel

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · International Relations

• Organisers of the “Red Line” demonstration called for stricter trade sanctions, a halt to arms sales, and an official declaration that Israel’s actions in Gaza amount to genocide

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Tens, Amsterdam, Dutch, Gaza, Israel

Source: The Hindu, International, 08 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/tens-of-thousands-march-in-amsterdam-pressing-

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

The ECI’s constitutional mandate is under strain

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Polity & Constitution, Governance & Social Justice

• The Election Commission of India’s conduct raises serious questions about legality, accountability and constitutional propriety

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: ECI, Election Commission of India

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 16 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/the-ecis-constitutional-mandate-is-under-strain/arti

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

ISRO’s latest navigation satellite NVS-03 is fully healthy, says Chairman V. Narayanan

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice

• ISRO to conduct in-orbit testing for satellite payload as part of developing NavIC, an indigenous GPS alternative; ISRO chief recalls Indian scientists’ role in saving lives on the Axiom-4 mission; praises Russian support of India’s space programme

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: ISRO, NVS-03, Chairman, Narayanan, NavIC

Source: The Hindu, Science, 05 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/chennai/isros-latest-navigation-satellite-nvs-03-is-f

How AI is reshaping China’s universities

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• AI disruption and a tightening job market are driving a sweeping change across China’s universities; under the government’s ‘guideline on the reform of higher education institutions’, universities will now be tasked with specific goals, pursuing either research, application-oriented objectives, or skills development

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: How AI, China

Source: The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/how-ai-is-reshaping-chinas-universities/articl

NVS-03 reaches geosynchronous orbit; satellite in good health

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice, Economy

• ‘Four orbit manoeuvres have been successfully completed with a cumulative LAM engine burn of 6164 seconds; with this the satellite has reached Geo Synchronous Orbit at an inclination of 29.980,’ said ISRO

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: NVS-03, Four, LAM, Geo Synchronous Orbit, ISRO

Source: The Hindu, Science, 05 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/nvs-03-reaches-geosynchronous-orbit-satellite-in

Study in Keralam sheds light on link between gut bacteria, Parkinson’s disease

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• Researchers from CUSAT and SCTIMST, Thiruvananthapuram, find significant differences between gut bacteria of Parkinson’s patients and those of healthy individuals

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Study, Keralam, Parkinson, Researchers, CUSAT and SCTIMST

Source: The Hindu, Science, 02 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/study-in-keralam-sheds-light-on-link-between

NASA telescope on verge of plunging back to Earth after failed rescue mission

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice, International Relations

• Most of the 1 ½-ton telescope is expected to burn up in the atmosphere.
• But a handful of pieces made of denser-than-lead tungsten and some mirror parts could survive reentry, according to NASA's Brad Cenko, the mission's chief scientist

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: NASA, Earth, Most, Brad Cenko

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/nasa-telescope-on-verge-of-plunging-back-to-eart

In Kashmir’s traditional rice, clues to a journey from East Asia

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, International Relations, Agriculture

• Kashmir’s traditional varieties carry cold-tolerance and other locally adapted genes that modern varieties have partly lost, making them potentially valuable as climate change increases stress on crops, new research has found.
• The analysis also indicated the varieties are more closely related to those from the Korean Peninsula and Northeast China

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Kashmir, East Asia, Korean Peninsula and Northeast China

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/in-kashmir-traditional-rice-clues-to-a-journey-f

GSLV places next-generation navigation satellite NVS-03 into orbit

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Governance & Social Justice, Economy

• The NVS-03, with a mission life of 12 years, is expected to restore the functioning of the NavIC constellation; satellite carries an indigenous atomic clock, along with procured atomic clocks

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: GSLV, NVS-03, NavIC

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/nvs-03-satellite-launch-successful-isro/article7

ALSO IN THE NEWS (LOWER PRIORITY)

• Pope Leo takes Milei to task as he visits divided Argentina (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
• From climate targets to energy justice (The Hindu, Environment, 26 Oct 2026)
• Maharashtra FDA seizes drugs, cosmetics worth ■34.51 lakh, cancels 122 licences (The Hindu, Health, 06 Nov 2026)
• Between pathogens, people and policy (The Hindu, Health, 04 Nov 2026)

GS Paper III: Economy, Environment, S&T, Security & DM

AGRICULTURE

Why Rayalaseema farmers fear a bumper crop more than drought; can the ■1-lakh-crore horticulture hub change that?

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• Farmers in the region fear a bumper yield the most, because the lack of cold storage and market linkages and exploitation by middlemen often force them into distress sales

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Why Rayalaseema, Farmers

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 29 Sep 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/why-rayalaseema-farmers-fear-a-bumpe

YSRCP leader criticises government’s response to El Nino crisis in Anantapur

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• Undivided Anantapur district is set to face an acute shortage of drinking water, irrigation water, and cattle fodder, while reduced crop cultivation during the previous Kharif season has already led to scarcity of fodder, claims Anantha Venkatarami Reddy

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: YSRCP, El Nino, Anantapur, Undivided Anantapur, Kharif

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 23 Aug 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/ysrcp-leader-criticises-governments-

Maharashtra drought: Farmer sends money order of ■5,000 to CM over ‘paltry’ interim aid by govt.

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• “I cultivated a soybean crop on 1.5 acres of my farm.
• I spent ■25,000 and received a 60-kg yield.

Prelims pointers

• I borrowed ■1,100 from my friend to send the money order,” Mr.
• Key terms: Maharashtra, Farmer, Shaikh, Surdi

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 18 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/maharashtra/maharashtra-drought-farmer-sends-money-

Cabinet approves hike in Rabi minimum support prices for 2027-28 season

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• The MSP for safflower was increased the most, by ■675 per quintal to ■7,215 per quintal, an increase of 10.3% over its level in the previous year

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cabinet, Rabi, MSP

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 01 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/cabinet-raises-wheat-msp-by-25-to-2610-per-quintal-

Don’t cultivate paddy this kharif, Andhra Pradesh tells Krishna delta farmers amid water crunch

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• Narasimha Murthy said storage in Srisailam and Nagarjuna Sagar had fallen to critically low levels, and that Pattiseema pumping may last only 60 to 70 days this season against 100 to 120 days earlier; farmers have been advised to switch to dry crops

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Don, Andhra Pradesh, Krishna, Engineer-in-Chief, Narasimha Murthy

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 24 Jul 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/dont-cultivate-paddy-this-kharif-and

No shortage of fertilisers in NTR district, says Collector

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Agriculture

• Lakshmisha says the government follows a transparent fertiliser distribution system through the A.P.
• Agribusiness Information Management System app, and fertilisers are given to farmers based on online land records

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: NTR, Collector, Lakshmisha, Agribusiness Information Management System

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 16 Jul 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/no-shortage-of-fertilisers-in-ntr-di

ECONOMY

The looming crisis of world unemployment

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy

• A widening jobs gap threatens the promise of demographic dividends; the Global South faces an unprecedented employment challenge

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Global South

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 06 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/the-looming-crisis-of-world-unemployment/article7154

Data suggests broad-based increase in food prices: RBI Bulletin

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Economy

• Inflation in rural areas was found to be higher than in urban areas; headline CPI inflation edged up over the months and showed signs of greater generalisation across commodities

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Data, RBI Bulletin, Inflation, CPI

Source: The Hindu, Economy, 24 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/data-suggests-broad-based-increase-in-food-price

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

Many parts of Delhi reel under ‘severe’ level air pollution

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• The 24-hour average Air Quality Index (AQI) of Delhi was 379 (very poor) at 9 a.m.
• on November 4, 2026, as per Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Many, Delhi, Air Quality Index, AQI, November

Source: The Hindu, Health, 04 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/many-parts-of-delhi-reel-under-severe-level-air

On paddy field conservation in Keralam

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• Neglecting paddy fields as a socio-ecological system that regulates local biodiversity, the hydrological cycle, and microclimate constitutes a grave failure, amid rising food insecurity and floods

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Keralam, Neglecting

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 21 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/on-paddy-field-conservation-in-keralam/article71605

From the brink to a comeback, hope for India’s wildlife

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• The current state of some of India’s endangered species is encouraging, but sustained conservation, science and local action remain essential

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: From

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 07 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/from-the-brink-to-a-comeback-hope-for-indias-wildlif

At COP31, the ‘overshoot’ narrative cannot replace climate action

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• No COP decision has referred to the quantitative value of the total or remaining carbon budget nor has discussed which countries have spent it the most.
• If COP31 is to deliver real impetus to climate action, its decisions must revert to the basics

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: At COP31, No COP, If COP31

Source: The Hindu, Science, 07 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/at-cop31-the-overshoot-narrative-

Taxonomic ‘chauvinism’ rife in ecological literature

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology, Economy, Science & Technology

• For instance, even though birds and mammals comprise less than 1 per cent of animal biodiversity, they dominate both conservation and research efforts, find two studies.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Taxonomic, For

Source: The Hindu, Science, 29 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/taxonomic-chauvinism-rife-in-ecol

As COP31 comes to Turkiye, satellites reveal a landfill methane problem

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Environment & Ecology

• Methane is the biggest cause of climate change after carbon dioxide (CO2) and is over 80 times more potent than CO2 in its first 20 years in the air.
• Sharp cuts could therefore slow warming relatively quickly

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: As COP31, Turkiye, Methane, CO2, Sharp

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 07 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/as-cop31-comes-to-turkiye-satelli

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Countdown progressing for ISRO’s crucial GSLV-F18 launch carrying navigation satellite NVS-03

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology

• The Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle carrying on board the GSLV-F18 rocket is scheduled to lift off at 11.51 p.m.
• on Friday (October 30, 2026) from the second launch pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Countdown, ISRO, GSLV-F18, NVS-03, Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle

Source: The Hindu, Science, 30 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/isros-crucial-gslv-f18-launch-carrying-navigatio

Why is ISRO’s NVS-03 satellite launch crucial? | Explained

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology

• The mission could help restore the functioning of India’s regional satellite navigation system NavIC; its development began following the 1999 Kargil War, when the U.S reportedly clamped down on GPS data access

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Why, ISRO, NVS-03, Explained, NavIC

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/why-is-isros-nvs-03-satellite-launch-crucial-exp

A global Centre of Excellence to come up in Coimbatore for research on sugarcane

HIGH IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Disaster Management, Agriculture

• The CoE will work on developing new varieties that will have higher yield and sugar recovery, enhanced tolerance to drought, flood, salinity, and heat stress, improved resistance to major diseases and pests

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Centre of Excellence, Coimbatore, CoE

Source: The Hindu, Agriculture, 08 Aug 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Coimbatore/a-global-centre-of-excellence-to-come-up-i

Beyond Kudankulam's fence, a cybersecurity challenge

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Agriculture

• The Kudankulam breach highlights vulnerabilities beyond a nuclear plant's physical boundaries

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Beyond Kudankulam, Kudankulam

Source: The Hindu, Lead (Op-Ed), 27 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/lead/beyond-kudankulams-fence-a-cybersecurity-challenge/a

A mother's hidden genes decide which way her snail baby spirals

MEDIUM IMPORTANCE · Both · Science & Technology, Economy, Environment & Ecology

• In 2023, after poring through photos posted online by hikers, a researcher found a location in north Japan where there were both left- and right-handed snails of a single species.
• Their shells also looked similar, suggesting the snails had interbred.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Japan, Their

Source: The Hindu, Science, 03 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/a-mothers-hidden-genes-decide-which-way-her-snai

ISRO NVS-03 launch: 5 things to know about India's new navigation satellite

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• ISRO successfully launched the NVS-03 navigation satellite from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota on October 30, 2026, restoring NavIC to a four-satellite, standalone operational status and advancing India's push for an indigenous, more precise space-time network

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: ISRO NVS-03, ISRO, NVS-03, Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/isro-nvs-03-launch-navic-constellation-5-things-

To overcome technical hurdles, ISRO flew NVS-03 satellite with pyro valves open: Narayanan

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• Pyro valves are crucial in spacecraft propulsion, and it may be recalled that the NVS-02 (launched in 2025), the second spacecraft in the NVS series, was a failure

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: ISRO, NVS-03, Narayanan, Pyro, NVS-02

Source: The Hindu, Science, 31 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/to-overcome-technical-hurdles-isro-flew-nvs-03-s

New genetic tools are breathing fresh life into India's staple crops

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• As new tools like apomixis become more widely available and private companies start investing more in Indian seeds, it is as important to think about how our system will adapt to these changes as it is to invest in fundamental research in plant genetics, physiology, development and host-pathogen interactions

Source: The Hindu, Science, 28 Oct 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/genetic-tools-apomixis-breathing-fresh-life-indi

Keralam’s mangrove cover expanded in past decade despite prior decline, finds study

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• Study by ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute based in Kochi compared satellite images from 2017 and 2026 to map changes in mangrove vegetation across Keralam’s coastal districts

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Keralam, Study, ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute, Kochi

Source: The Hindu, Environment, 06 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/keralams-mangrove-cover-expanded-in-past-dec

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